

Accommodation & Hotel Policy

Policy ID: ACC-003 | Version: 1.0 | Effective date: 1 January 2026

Document status: Detailed fictional enterprise reference policy for RAG development and testing.

Important: This document is a reference policy, not an actual policy issued by a specific company. Replace rates, approval authorities, tax treatment and local requirements with your organization's approved rules before production use.

Purpose

Defines hotel eligibility, city limits, reimbursable charges, exceptions and documentation.

1. Scope and Definitions

Applies to employees, contractors and other workers who incur authorized business travel expenses.

1.1 Business Travel

Business travel means travel away from an employee's normal work location for an approved business purpose.

1.2 Policy Principles

- Expenses must have a legitimate business purpose.
- Employees must use reasonable and economical options.
- Expenses must be submitted accurately and on time.
- Duplicate reimbursement is prohibited.
- Falsified or altered receipts may result in disciplinary action.

2. Roles and Responsibilities

Employee

- Obtain required approval.
- Use approved suppliers where available.
- Retain receipts and supporting evidence.
- Submit complete and accurate claims.
- Repay unused advances or personal amounts.

Manager

- Confirm business purpose and necessity.
- Review reasonableness and documentation.
- Approve exceptions only within delegated authority.
- Escalate suspected fraud.

Finance

- Maintain controls and audit procedures.
- Validate claims.
- Process approved reimbursement.
- Maintain records under retention requirements.

3. Hotel Eligibility

Accommodation is reimbursable when an employee is required to stay overnight for authorized business travel. Hotels should be safe, reasonable and within the applicable limit.

4. Illustrative City Limits

Location	Nightly limit	Currency	Notes
Mumbai	8,000	INR	Illustrative

Location	Nightly limit	Currency	Notes
Delhi	8,000	INR	Illustrative
London	200	GBP	Illustrative
New York	250	USD	Illustrative
Singapore	250	SGD	Illustrative

Production use requires the organization's current city rate table and effective date.

5. Reimbursable Hotel Charges

- Room rate within approved limit.
- Mandatory hotel taxes and statutory charges.
- Business internet where required and not included.
- Reasonable business parking.

6. Non-Reimbursable Hotel Charges

- Mini-bar and personal food.
- Movies and entertainment.
- Spa or wellness services.
- Personal room upgrades.
- Personal late checkout.
- Guest charges unrelated to business.

7. Exceeding the Hotel Limit

If no compliant hotel is reasonably available, seek an exception before booking where practical. Emergency or market-condition exceptions must be documented and approved retrospectively under the exception matrix.

8. Shared Rooms and Multiple Travelers

Shared accommodation may be used where appropriate. Reimbursement must not exceed actual eligible cost and must not create duplicate claims.

9. Cancellations and No-Shows

Cancellation fees are reimbursable when caused by a business change, travel disruption or approved circumstance. Personal no-show charges are not reimbursable.

10. Long Stays

For stays exceeding 14 nights, consult Travel/Finance about negotiated rates, serviced apartments or other approved arrangements.

11. Hotel Documentation

The folio should identify guest, stay dates, room rate, taxes and other charges. A credit-card slip alone is generally insufficient when an itemized folio is available.

12. FAQs

The hotel is above the city limit. Can I claim it?

Only under the approved exception process or where a higher limit specifically applies.

Can I claim hotel breakfast?

Only if it is not already included in another reimbursed arrangement and is otherwise eligible.

Can I book alternative lodging?

Only if the accommodation policy permits it and applicable safety, tax and approval requirements are met.